EDM Storm Overflow Annual Return Summary Reporting 2025

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Table 1: 2025 EDM Headlines	Anglian Water (AWS)	Dwr Cymru Welsh Water (DC/WW) (in England)	Northumbrian Water (NW)	Severn Trent Water (SvT)	South West Water (SWW)	Southern Water (SW)	Thames Water (TW)	United Utilities (UU)	Wessex Water (WSSX)	Yorkshire Water (YWS)	Water Company Total	Water Company Average
Total number of storm overflows listed in the annual return in 2025	1,442	122	1,561	2,452	1,365	977	581	2,270	1,346	2,187	**14,303**	**-**
Total number of active storm overflows listed in the annual return in 2025	1,442	122	1,561	2,432	1,358	977	580	2,270	1,346	2,184	**14,272**	**-**
Total number of storm overflows with EDM commissioned	1,442	122	1,561	2,432	1,358	977	580	2,270	1,346	2,184	**14,272**	**-**
% active storm overflows listed with EDM commissioned	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**
Total number of storm overflows with spill data in 2025	1,438	122	1,559	2,431	1,357	975	579	2,270	1,332	2,176	**14,239**	**-**
Average number of spills per storm overflow with spill data in 2025	12.0	23.3	17.8	15.0	34.0	16.0	15.9	26.8	18.3	23.6	**-**	**20.5**
Average duration (hrs) per monitored spill event in 2025	6.1	5.1	4.4	5.5	8.8	7.4	11.7	5.4	7.8	5.6	**-**	**6.4**

Table 2: 2025 EDM Summary Statistics	Anglian Water (AWS)	Dwr Cymru Welsh Water (DC/WW) (in England)	Northumbrian Water (NW)	Severn Trent Water (SvT)	South West Water (SWW)	Southern Water (SW)	Thames Water (TW)	United Utilities (UU)	Wessex Water (WSSX)	Yorkshire Water (YWS)	Water Company Total	Water Company Average
Total number of monitored spill events in 2025	17,322	2,843	27,860	36,471	46,164	15,554	9,189	60,843	24,442	51,431	**292,119**	**-**
Average number of spills per storm overflow with spill data in 2025	12.0	23.3	17.8	15.0	34.0	16.0	15.9	26.8	18.3	23.6	**-**	**20.5**
Total duration (hrs) of monitored spill events in 2025	105,806	14,525	123,803	200,361	407,006	114,868	107,822	327,453	190,666	285,931	**1,878,240**	**-**
Average duration (hrs) per monitored spill event in 2025	6.1	5.1	4.4	5.5	8.8	7.4	11.7	5.4	7.8	5.6	**-**	**6.4**
% storm overflows spilled ≤10 times in 2025	64.8%	42.6%	49.8%	55.9%	36.7%	57.2%	59.4%	43.3%	48.6%	41.3%	**-**	**49.5%**
% time operating [spilling] during 2025 per overflow (average)	0.8%	1.4%	0.9%	0.9%	3.4%	1.3%	2.1%	1.6%	1.6%	1.5%	**-**	**1.5%**

Table 3: 2025 EDM Device Operation	Anglian Water (AWS)	Dwr Cymru Welsh Water (DC/WW) (in England)	Northumbrian Water (NW)	Severn Trent Water (SvT)	South West Water (SWW)	Southern Water (SW)	Thames Water (TW)	United Utilities (UU)	Wessex Water (WSSX)	Yorkshire Water (YWS)	Water Company Total	Water Company Average
Total number of storm overflows with EDM Operation data	1,442	122	1,561	2,432	1,358	977	580	2,270	1,342	2,184	**14,268**	**-**
% storm overflows with EDM Operation data provided where expected	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**
% storm overflows with 0% EDM Operation during reporting period	0.28%	0%	0.13%	0.04%	0.07%	0.20%	0.17%	0%	0%	0.37%	**-**	**0.13%**
% storm overflows with ≥90% EDM Operation during reporting period	91.7%	96%	87.1%	96.3%	96.7%	88.2%	94.5%	91.5%	97.5%	90.7%	**-**	**92.7%**
% storm overflows with <90% EDM Operation during reporting period	8.3%	4.1%	12.9%	3.7%	3.3%	11.8%	5.5%	8.5%	2.5%	9.3%	**-**	**7.3%**
% of those with <90% operability with reason provided	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**

Table 4: 2025 Storm Overflow Spill Performance	Anglian Water (AWS)	Dwr Cymru Welsh Water (DC/WW) (in England)	Northumbrian Water (NW)	Severn Trent Water (SvT)	South West Water (SWW)	Southern Water (SW)	Thames Water (TW)	United Utilities (UU)	Wessex Water (WSSX)	Yorkshire Water (YWS)	Water Company Total	Water Company Average
% with EDM installed & provided count data - with 0 spill count (did not spill)	17.0%	7.4%	16.4%	17.6%	13.1%	17.9%	23.3%	13.0%	16.5%	13.4%	**-**	**15.7%**
% storm overflows with spill data - recorded ≥1 spill count	83.0%	92.6%	83.6%	82.4%	86.9%	82.1%	76.7%	87.0%	83.5%	86.6%	**-**	**84.3%**
% recorded 5 spills or less	49.0%	28.7%	37.9%	41.5%	28.3%	44.5%	48.2%	33.0%	35.2%	30.3%	**-**	**37.3%**
% recorded 10 spills or less	64.8%	42.6%	49.8%	55.9%	36.7%	57.2%	59.4%	43.3%	48.6%	41.3%	**-**	**49.5%**
% recorded >10 spills	35.2%	57.4%	50.2%	44.1%	63.3%	42.8%	40.6%	56.7%	51.4%	58.7%	**-**	**50.5%**
% recorded 20 spills or more	20.5%	46.7%	35.0%	27.8%	52.2%	29.0%	29.2%	45.3%	35.5%	45.0%	**-**	**36.6%**
% recorded 40 spills or more	6.6%	20.5%	13.7%	10.2%	32.6%	12.8%	11.7%	26.3%	15.3%	21.7%	**-**	**17.5%**
% recorded 60 spills or more	2.7%	8.2%	4.6%	3.1%	20.8%	4.6%	5.0%	14.1%	4.8%	9.5%	**-**	**8.0%**
% recorded 100 spills or more	0.6%	1.6%	0.8%	0.5%	7.4%	0.6%	1.2%	3.4%	0.6%	1.5%	**-**	**1.8%**
% recorded 200 spills or more	0%	0%	0%	0%	0.29%	0%	0%	0.04%	0%	0.05%	**-**	**0.04%**

Table 5: 2025 Storm Overflow Spill Reasons Please note these metrics are in development. In 2025 there is some inconsistency in approach by different Water & Sewerage Companies	Anglian Water (AWS)	Dwr Cymru Welsh Water (DC/WW) (in England)	Northumbrian Water (NW)	Severn Trent Water (SvT)	South West Water (SWW)	Southern Water (SW)	Thames Water (TW)	United Utilities (UU)	Wessex Water (WSSX)	Yorkshire Water (YWS)	Water Company Total	Water Company Average
Number of monitored storm overflows that spilled >30 in one year	149	37	336	379	552	186	108	775	294	670	**3,486**	**-**
Of those that spilled over SOAF thresholds of >30x in one year, % with a reason provided	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**
Of those that spilled over SOAF thresholds of >30x in one year, what % due to exceptional rainfall throughout the year?	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%	5.3%	0%	0%	**-**	**1.2%**
Of those that spilled over SOAF thresholds of >30x in one year, what % due to other operational (incl. asset maintenance)?	32.9%	0%	19.3%	7.9%	35.9%	47.3%	70.4%	12.5%	0.3%	11.2%	**-**	**19.5%**
Of those that spilled over SOAF thresholds of >30x in one year, what % due to hydraulic capacity reasons?	46%	0%	78.3%	92.1%	37.3%	52.7%	26.9%	82.2%	0%	88.4%	**-**	**64.3%**
Of those that spilled over SOAF thresholds of >30x in one year, what % N/A - Ongoing Investigation for primary reason?	21.5%	100%	2.4%	0%	26.8%	0%	2.8%	0%	99.7%	0.4%	**-**	**15.0%**

Storm overflows are permitted to operate due to rainfall and/or snowmelt. The root cause for high spill frequency can be attributed to three main reasons over and above response to typical rainfall. These are fully defined in the Storm Overflow Assessment Framework (SOAF) and summarised below.

Exceptional rainfall: This does not refer to individual rainfall events, but rather the rainfall across the reporting year. Two datasets can be used to determine whether rainfall in the reporting year was "exceptional" or not (over & above typical rainfall) – (1) Environment Agency water situation reports or (2) local rainfall records.

If rainfall was exceptional and deemed the primary reason for high spill count then this is indicated in the annual return (Column W).

Asset Maintenance: Where the asset (storm overflow) and potentially parts of the upstream & downstream sewer network have not operated as designed/expected, high spill counts (over 30 times per year) can be caused.

If asset maintenance is deemed the primary reason for high spill count this is indicated in the annual return (column W). The different asset maintenance categories are listed in the EDM dataset README guide Appendix A.

Hydraulic capacity: If the reason for a high spilling storm overflow (over 30 times per year) is neither "exceptional rainfall" nor "asset maintenance" then the reason is classified under the "Hydraulic capacity" category.

This indicates there is insufficient capacity (conveyance or storage) in the sewer network to cope with the wastewater flow plus typical rainfall entering the sewer network.

Link to: Storm Overflow Assessment Framework (SOAF)

Table 6: 2025 EDM Storm Overflow Annual Return Data Entry	Anglian Water (AWS)	Dwr Cymru Welsh Water (DC/WW) (in England)	Northumbrian Water (NW)	Severn Trent Water (SvT)	South West Water (SWW)	Southern Water (SW)	Thames Water (TW)	United Utilities (UU)	Wessex Water (WSSX)	Yorkshire Water (YWS)	Water Company Total	Water Company Average
Total number of storm overflows listed in the annual return in 2025	1,442	122	1,561	2,452	1,365	977	581	2,270	1,346	2,187	**14,303**	**-**
Total number of storm overflows with EDM commissioned	1,442	122	1,561	2,432	1,358	977	580	2,270	1,346	2,184	**14,272**	**-**
% 'active' storm overflows listed with EDM commissioned	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**
Total number of storm overflows with EDM device operability data	1,442	122	1,561	2,432	1,358	977	580	2,270	1,342	2,184	**14,268**	**-**
% storm overflows with EDM Operation data provided where expected	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**
Total number of storm overflows with spill data	1,438	122	1,559	2,431	1,357	975	579	2,270	1,332	2,176	**14,239**	**-**
% storm overflows listed with spill data	99.7%	100%	99.9%	100%	99.9%	99.8%	99.8%	100%	99.0%	99.6%	**-**	**99.8%**
% storm overflows with <90% operability where valid reason provided	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**
% of storm overflows >30 spills in one year with a reason provided	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	100%	**-**	**100%**

Table 7: 2025 Treatment of Storm Overflows	Anglian Water (AWS)	Dwr Cymru Welsh Water (DC/WW) (in England)	North umbrian Water (NW)	Severn Trent Water (SvT)	South West Water (SWW)	Southern Water (SW)	Thames Water (TW)	United Utilities (UU)	Wessex Water (WSSX)	Yorkshire Water (YWS)	Water Company Totals	Water Company Averages
% of active storm overflows with treatment listed	0.97%	0%	0%	1.27%	0.22%	0.10%	5.34%	0.18%	0.45%	0.05%	-	**0.63%**
% of spills from active storm overflows with treatment listed	2.36%	0%	0%	3.56%	0.50%	0.40%	9.58%	0.23%	1.34%	0.09%	-	**1.16%**
% of spill duration from active storm overflows with treatment listed	2.00%	0%	0%	6.75%	0.42%	0.86%	10.21%	0.44%	2.75%	0.13%	-	**1.94%**